

FILM REVIEW

STRIKER

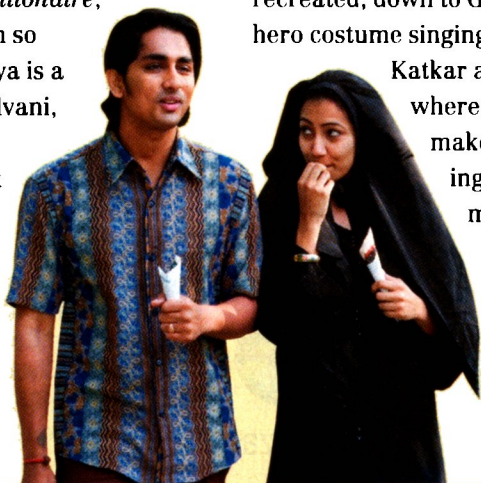
Minimal Lives,
Maximum City

RATING ★ ★ ★ ☆

Director: Chandan Arora

Starring: Siddharth, Ankur Vikal

Mangne se kuch nahin milta. Chheenna galat hai. Jeetna padega. It's a new take on *Slumdog Millionaire*, albeit not made with so much panache. Surya is a boy who lives in Malvani, where Hindus and Muslims lived cheek by jowl until the 1992 riots. He's a carrom star on edge of genteel poverty. This is his story, as he negotiates life in



pre-1992 Mumbai, partly in flashback, resisting the lure of the diabolical ganglord, played with due menace by Aditya Pancholi. There's tension in *Striker*, of life lived on the run from the police and the goondas, of the brittle relations between Hindus and Muslims, and of the terrifying prospect of joblessness. There's also the audacity of hope, of an escape to the Gulf, of romance with a Muslim girl, sometimes of just life. The era has been perfectly recreated, down to Govinda in super-hero costume singing a song with Kimi

Katkar and shirt collars where an airplane could make a smooth landing. It's about minimal lives in the maximum city, the nightmare in the city of dreams. It could have been a contender.

by Kaveree Bamzai

MUSIC FESTIVAL

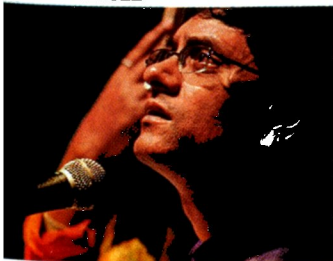
Rhythm Divine

Sitar maestro Pandit Ravi Shankar had a dream which was to conceptualise a place where musicians from different gharanas would come and exchange musical ideas. The dream was realised in the form of the Ravi Shankar Institute of Performing Arts in Delhi where he now organises a four-day festival every year. From February 25 to 28, the

festival features Rajendra Prasanna and Sanjeev Shankar (shehnai), Divya Sivasundar (Bharatanatyam), Kushal Das (sitar), Sarathi Chatterjee (vocal), Shalini Patnaik (Odissi) and Saswati Sen (Kathak). Watch out for young Shankar, disciple of Ravi Shankar, who has developed a style of his own with clarity of notes and melody.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

CHATTERJEE



SANJEEV



SIVASUNDAR



ART EXHIBITION

Human TOUCH

Veteran artist Rajeswara Rao's works have always portrayed human activity while bordering on kitsch. His present solo show *Phir Wohi Doodh* in Kolkata, shows a shift from the situational to the personal and from the local to the universal. His choice of medium, watercolours and acrylic on acrylic sheet, has heightened the dimension of this sensibility. Satire finds a notable position in Rao's works and his paintings tell a story of the common man—their dreams, aspirations, greed and sorrow. In this exhibition, he draws a thin, yet definitive line between pleasure and pain. The portraits almost stare straight at the viewer, especially in works titled *Dubai Gold*, *Don't Be Silly*, *Lachmi* and *First Night*. In *Goa*, a woman relaxing on the beach and in *Main Hoon Na* the ardent embrace of lovers are eye catching. At the Gallery Sanskriti in Kolkata till February 2.

by Elora Sen